Derck Prinzhorn

AI safety and security research

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Experience

Exponential Security Labs Jul 2026 – present
Founding Member of Technical Staff
Work on multi-agent security environments and evaluations, red-teaming frontier agents, and defenses for agentic systems.

Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems & ELLIS Institute Tübingen Jan – Aug 2026
Research Intern
Researched AI control with Maksym Andriushchenko, focusing on agent monitoring and oversight.

Aithos Research Lab Apr 2025 – Jan 2026
Research Engineer
Worked on evaluations of AI value systems and moral competence.

University of Amsterdam Jan 2024 – Feb 2025
Research Intern
Researched conformal prediction for time series, radiotherapy dose prediction, and physical reasoning in video generation.

Dutch Police Apr 2023 – Apr 2025
AI Architect
Defined reference architectures for AI, MLOps, and AI security.

Selected Research Project

Controlling the Researcher: AI Control Evaluations for Automated AI R&D 2026
Co-developed control evaluations spanning safety fine-tuning, RL post-training, and CUDA optimization. Subtle sabotage embedded in research artifacts evaded most evaluated monitors; overt side tasks were easier to detect.

Selected Publications

Instrumental Monitor Evasion Emerges Under Ordinary Task Pressure
D. Schmotz, **D. Prinzhorn**, L. Beurer-Kellner, A. Paulus, A. Prabhu, M. Andriushchenko. arXiv, 2026.

LLM Agents Can Easily Tamper With Their Own Traces
J. Qin, D. Schmotz, **D. Prinzhorn**, L. Beurer-Kellner, A. Prabhu, M. Andriushchenko. arXiv, 2026.

ResearchArena: Evaluating Sabotage and Monitoring in Automated AI R&D
L. Libon, B. Rank, J. Yeon, D. Schmotz, J. Qin, D. Donnelly, **D. Prinzhorn**, M. Andriushchenko. COLM Workshop on Agent Behavior, 2026.

Evaluating Newtonian Mechanics in Video Generative Models with Real Physical Systems
A. Tragoudaras, C. Zhang, D. Cherniavskii, A. Vozikis, T. Nijdam, **D. Prinzhorn**, et al. ICML, 2026.

Conformal Time Series Decomposition with Component-wise Exchangeability
D. Prinzhorn, T. Nijdam, P. van der Linden, A. Timans. COPA, 2024.

Education

MSc Artificial Intelligence, University of Amsterdam 2023 – 2026
Thesis research on AI control at the Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems and ELLIS Institute Tübingen.

BSc Artificial Intelligence, University of Amsterdam 2020 – 2023
Graduated cum laude; AmsterdamAI Thesis Award for work on uncertainty quantification in time series.